



MARKET RESEARCHER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Market researchers gather information to help organizations understand the needs and preferences of customers, and to assist with developing new products. They carry out surveys by telephone, mail, online, or in person, and analyze the results to produce reports of people's opinions about a product, brand, or a political or social issue.



SALARY

Market researcher ★★☆☆☆

Market research director ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Marketing agencies are largest employers • Industry in decline in Middle East and Europe, but growing in most other parts of the world

CAREER PATHS

A degree is usually required to enter the market research sector, which includes marketing agencies, businesses, government departments, or nonprofits. Early in their career, market researchers collect and analyze information. With experience, they may choose to conduct research for clients, give presentations, or manage teams on projects.

HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATE You can find work as a market research assistant if you have good literacy and numerical skills; experience in customer service is also beneficial. You can combine working as an assistant with studying part-time for a degree in a related subject.

COLLEGE GRADUATE You need a degree, preferably in psychology, sociology, mathematics, or statistics, to enter the profession as a graduate. You may be expected to study for accreditation to improve your career prospects.



DATA ANALYST Specializes in using statistical and mathematical methods to analyze market research data. Data analysts interpret the results and present their findings to clients.



MARKET RESEARCHER You can stay in touch with advances in research methods by taking professional courses. You may specialize in areas such as ethnographic research—observing people at home or work to understand their needs better—or move into management or sales roles.

